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version of NT came out in the year 1993 and has since been used by all successors.

Most common Linux distributions, including Ubuntu and Fedora, have in-built support for the NTFS partitions and can, both read and write to it without any hassle. All you have to do is mount the NTFS partitions the way you'd mount any other partition and you're done. The problem arises when you try using the NTFS partition with OS X. By default, you can read NTFS partition in OS X but you can't write into an NTFS partition. If you want to write into an NTFS partition, use one of the following methods:

1. **Paid software:** There are a number of paid software available in the market that make it quite easy to read and write to NTFS partitions in OS X. The most commonly used paid software is 'Paragon'. The software costs around \$20 (₹1,271), and after installation you can mount NTFS partitions just like you'd mount a native partition.
2. **The terminal:** Another way to mount the partition and read and write to it is by using the terminal. Open the terminal and follow these steps:
 - Enter `sudo nano /etc/fstab` followed by your password.
 - A new program called 'nano' will pop up that doesn't look much different than the terminal. Enter `LABEL=drivename none ntfs rw, auto, nobrowse` where you need to replace "drivename" with the name of the drive.
 - Press [Ctrl] + [O] to save the changes and [Ctrl] + [X] to exit the program.
 - Unmount and unplug the drive.
 - Once you plug it back in, you won't see the drive pop up in the finder anymore. To see the drive, select 'go to folder' in the finder's menubar > Enter / volumes > Press [Enter].
 - Once inside the hidden Volumes folder, you'll see your drive mounted and ready to be accessed. You can also pin the drive to favourites for easy access.
3. **NTFS3G and FUSE:** Another technique that lets you read and write NTFS drives uses these two software. Download and install 'OSXFUSE' and

'NTFS-3G'. Both these software install the necessary drivers to read and write NTFS drives on your Mac. But you may face a slight problem. Once you restart your computer, you'll be bombarded with a number of errors because NTFS-3G won't be able to read your other HFS+ drives. To make these errors go away, all you need to do is download a nifty little software called 'fuse-wait' and you're all done.

HFS+ (OS X)

HFS and HFS+ are the file systems preferred by Mac OS X, and they aren't compatible with Linux and Windows. So what do you do when you have a HFS+ formatted pen drive that isn't opening on your Linux/Windows computer? Don't worry, we'll tell you what to do.

Linux, by default, supports HFS and HFS+ file systems in read only mode only. However, there's a way to change that too. (using 'HFSplus')

To do it, follow these steps:

- Open the terminal and enter `sudo apt-get install hfsprogs`
- Once the installation is done, remount the drive.
- Type in `sudo mount -t hfsplus -o remount,force,rw /mount/point` and voila, you're done! Now you should be able to both, read and write to the file in Linux.

Ext2, 3 and 4 (Linux)

Linux uses Ext partitions, with Ext4 being the latest iteration. Neither Mac nor Windows can natively read and write to Ext partitions, however, there are a number of third-party software available that let you do this. In Windows, you can access ext partitions by downloading and installing 'Ext2fsd', which is basically a file system driver that provides you with read only access to the HFS+ partition. Though you can enable write support for ext2 and ext3 partitions, we recommend against it since



Paragon lets you open HFS+ drive in Windows

While Linux can at least read the format, Windows can't even do that. There are a number of software in the market, both free and paid, that let you access the HFS drive.

One such free software that lets you access HFS+ partitions in Windows is 'HFSExplorer'. It lets you read and copy the contents from the partition, but sadly won't let you write to it. 'Paragon' and 'MacDrive' are paid alternatives that let you do both tasks.

To write to a HFS+ drive in Linux, you must install a program called 'hfsprogs'.

you risk your data getting corrupted. Another popular alternative is the 'DiskInternals Linux Reader' that comes with its own in-built file explorer and lets you read the ext partition. There's unfortunately no free and stable way to write to ext partitions. But look online and you'll find hacks that may or may not work. The best bet, if you really want to write to an ext partition, is 'Paragon ExtFS' that retails for around \$20 (₹1,271).

There are two ways to open it in OS X. The first way being buying a paid soft-